



April 2026 50th Year of Growth 1976 - 2026



Contact Email: doncastergardenclubinc@gmail.com

Web Address: www.doncastergardenclubaus.com

The DGC committee meeting was held on 1 April 2026 at 7.30 pm.

The next DGC meeting will be held on **Wednesday, 8 April 2026**
7.30 pm at the RSL Hall , cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street. Doors open at 7.15pm

At this meeting Craig Castree will talk about Companion Planting

Committee Members 2026

President

Avril Clark

0402 478 302

doncastergardenclubinc@gmail.com

Vice-President & Speaker

Bookings:

Vacant

Treasurer:

Dr Margaret Salter

Secretary:

Virgina Roberts & Connie Lee

secretary@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Fund Raising Co-Ordinator:

Anita Luzzza

Newsletter:

Rohini Padey

newseditor@doncastergardenclubaus.com

Reinhard

Esther Sim

Ray Brett

President's message April 2026

I trust you have all had a productive month. I was so thrilled to have some decent rain and the garden looks so much better. Hopefully it will continue on this month. This month on my gardening agenda I am finishing preparing my small no dig garden – photos next month! I have also purchased a lot of new bulbs – Miniature daffodils, Fritillaries, Crocus, Ixia and Snowdrops which I will be potting up in pots inspired by Anya Lautenbach's new book on Container gardens. I am also looking for someone to help me booking the Speakers for 2027. As you are aware Pauline has resigned due to more health issues and so I will be adding this to my President's role. I need someone who would be able to email and confirm Speakers and do the paperwork involved (not much). I am happy to train someone if they are interested or just to follow my instructions.

Please let me know if you are willing to help me.

If you are recommending Speakers please provide the following information:

1. Name
2. Email and Phone number
3. Topic

The Open Garden at "Garden of Hope" is coming up on Sunday 19th April. This garden is designed by Jacqui Chirgwin and it is a beautiful peaceful haven.

The address is 8 Beverley Hills Drive, Templestowe. The entry fee is \$10 and part of it goes to cancer research. The location is a short walk from the Pines shopping centre so very accessible by public transport.

Happy Gardening

Avril

Presentation for March - Gardens of Australia

We had a photograph presentation by Maureen and Paul Lucas. Maureen is an expert gardener and is the Director of Awards for Gardening Clubs of Australia. She is on the judging panel for garden competitions. Paul is an award winning photographer. The slideshow was a visual treat and it had around 170 photographs of various gardens all over Australia. Maureen shared some information about the gardens and what she liked in the garden and named some of the unusual plants/trees.

The pictures were stunning and there were magnificent views in each shot. Paul talked about different aspects of the gardens and what he found fascinating about the gardens. He talked about the different features in the gardens and how form and structure were created to draw your eyes to the plants.

He had pictures of the gardens with stunning trees, flowers and garden decorations. He talked about the different types of garden ornaments used to create a story. The layouts of the gardens and their shapes also weave a story.

Some of the gardens that he showed us pictures of are listed below, I would recommend that you visit the gardens and see the amazing views.

Botanic Gardens in Dandenongs - The Rhodendrons look beautiful in full bloom and the fall colours are great in this garden

Cranbourne Botanic Gardens - This garden is a native garden and it has some beautiful plants that you would not see in many gardens

Cloudehill in Olinda - He had some beautiful pictures of the pathways in this garden. They have created different rooms in this garden.

Werribee Rose Garden - The roses in this garden are beautiful and there were some beautiful pictures of them.

National Arboretum Canberra - There is a stunning display of trees.



How to ... get rid of rust on mint (by Robin Gale-Baker)

Article Courtesy LFC News March 18

Rust is a worldwide phenomenon. The spores travel on wind and water. While you may not be able to do anything about wind, the ways that you water can help slow rust developing on the leaves. Rust splashes from the soil onto the lower leaves when a hard spray of water is used so you should water with a gentle stream without disturbing the soil. Watering directly onto the soil also prevents the rust leaping from lower leaves to higher ones. If your mint is covered in rust (those reddish splotches more evident on the underside of leaves), cut all stems back to ground level in the pot or garden – ground level means that there are no stems to be seen sticking out of the soil. Then remove all debris, which will include dead leaves from the soil surface, and cover with several centimetres of fresh potting mix. The new shoots should be rust free.

So that I have mint year round, I have 2 containers and cut the first one of them back every 6-8 weeks, and the other one 6-8 weeks after the first.

Upcoming calendar events:

Upcoming Committee Meeting:	01 April	hosted by Avril Clark, 7.30pm at 62 Pine Hill Drive Doncaster East
Upcoming Meeting:	08 April	at the RSL Hall, 7.30pm at cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street Doncaster East

Following Committee Meeting:	06 May	hosted by Avril Clark, 7.30pm at 62 Pine Hill Drive Doncaster East
Following Meeting:	13 May	at the RSL Hall, 7.30pm at cnr Doncaster Road and Leeds Street Doncaster East

The speaker at the next meeting in May will be Paul Davies, Director Heathmont Honey

Hello Gardeners All

The tomatoes and cucumbers are out, bar one of each. The netted broccoli are growing well. There was still one cabbage butterfly in the garden on 24th March. I have bok choy, collards (loose leaf cabbage) and lettuce seedlings ready to transplant when this welcome rain ceases and I can add rock dust and Blood & Bone to the beds, then sugar cane mulch. (Done on 28th between showers). They are netted from rats and possums!

The pumpkin patch has had all branches of vine without pumpkins removed to help all growth go to the pumpkins. 2 tromboncino are huge and ripening. They eat like pumpkin and, I believe, related to the butternut pumpkin. One zucchini is out and the other is almost ready. The Canario bush beans which did very poorly have a small number of pods with seeds to mature for next season. There's also poor cropping on the few flat bean plants. The first Peas are 150mm high and the next lot are above ground.

Unfortunately, I had Queensland Fruit Fly in all the capsicums. They have been a lost cause.

My 2 rows of tiny **radish** plants started disappearing so they are now netted. It could have been either rats or possums. The **rhubarb** has been a slow but steady producer. More water would have helped. The **choko** is just coming into buds so the 2 days of COLD may disrupt flower formation with no choko to follow. It will like the Easter warmer weather. Some **carrot** seed is up.

For 2-3 days I noticed a small number of dying bees in my garden. A week later Trevor noticed our neighbour on one side had poisoned his weeds next to all his concrete paths. So disappointing that people do not understand the connection.

Rain by March is 66mm.

Damage is clear on 2 late set pumpkins.

Jerusalem Artichoke bush - harvest in winter when plant dies back



Happy Gardening Pauline

From my Bookshelf April 2026

The man who planted Canberra: Charles Weston and his three million trees.

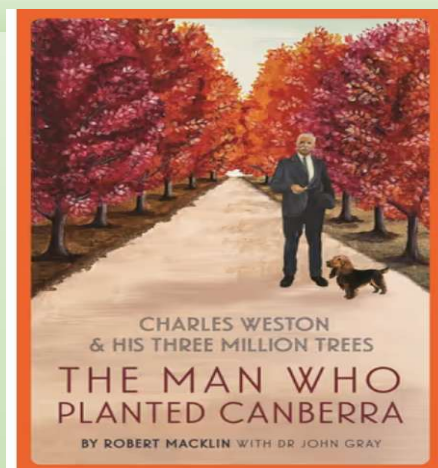
written by Robert Macklin

If I said Walter Burley Griffin everyone would immediately know who I was talking about, but I'm sure not one of you have heard of Charles Weston.. This amazing man is the subject of a book published in 2025 explores 'Charles Weston's truly remarkable feat of afforestation in the formative years of the national capital.' The book draws heavily on the late John Gray's doctoral thesis of Charles Weston and provides a fascinating insight into the preparation, vision and implementation of his task on the dry, barren Limestone Plains overrun by rabbits and squabbled over by architects, town planners and bureaucrats. Out of all of this the capital city of Canberra miraculously took shape and transformed into what we see today.

Charles Weston (1866 – 1935) began life in a village near what is now London's Heathrow airport. The family were always keen on growing their own fruit and vegetables and young Charles also showed keen academic ability. Unfortunately the family did not have the money to further this interest and so he secured a gardening apprenticeship at the nearby Poyle Manor and from there moved to Drumlanrig Castle on the Scottish border. At Drumlanrig he worked under David Thomson who was a very influential head gardener of the time. In 1892 Weston was appointed foreman overseeing fruit production.

Weston , by 1896, was wanting to spread his wings and found Britain already full of aspirational gardeners at his level expertise. Armed with many glowing testimonials he set sail for Australia. After spending 15 years in Sydney expanding his knowledge of Australian horticulture he was well positioned for his new position as Head Gardener of the Federal Government House in Sydney . As his reputation grew he was approached by the Federal Government for his advice "about a possible nursery at the site for the capital." In due course a 40 acre site was decided upon at Yarralumla for an experimental and nursery area. Later a demonstration arboretum comprising 120 hectares, was added. It was here, over the course of the next years that Weston would meticulously document millions of trees and their growth habits for use in Canberra when it was built.

The book provides wonderful insights into the visions of Burley Griffin, Weston and the bureaucrats and the discussions, arguments, financial woes of bringing this dream to life. Today's Canberra is testament to the architectural, town planning genius of Burley Griffin and having read this amazing book it is evident that Weston's visionary plantings have amplified, softened and gilded our Capital City. The book is highly recommended to read and celebrates the achievements of this visionary gardener who should be recognised more highly for his work.



Autumn plantings

Here is a list of what you can plant in August from the LFC website, see link below

<https://localfoodconnect.org.au/community-gardening/autumn-plantings/>

The list is extensive and can be found on the LFC website, a select few are named below

Brassicas

Broccoli	Brussel sprouts	Cabbage	Cauliflower	Chinese cabbage	Kale
Kohl rabi	Mizuna	Mustard greens	Tatsoi		

Other veggies

Beetroot	Broad beans	Celery	Endive	Fennel (Florence)	Garlic
Leek	Lettuce	Onions	Peas	Radish	Rocket
Silverbeet	Spinach				

Herbs

Coriander	Marjoram	Oregano	Rosemary	Thyme	Kale
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Zucchini Fritters - recipe by Nigella Lawson

4 zucchini (approx. 1 pounds)

5 -6 scallions, finely chopped

9ounces feta cheese

1small bunch fresh parsley, chopped

1small bunch of fresh mint, chopped

1tablespoon dried mint

1teaspoon paprika

1cup all-purpose flour

Salt and pepper to taste

3eggs, beaten

olive oil, for frying

3 -4 limes for serving

Coarsely grate the zucchini with either the grating blade in the food processor or by hand. Spread the little shards out on a tea towel and leave for about 20 minutes to get rid of any excess wetness.

Put the chopped scallions in a bowl and crumble in the feta. Stir in the chopped parsley and mint, along with the dried mint and paprika. Add the flour and season well with salt and pepper. Gradually add the beaten egg and mix thoroughly before stirring in the drained, grated zucchini. Don't be alarmed by the unflowing straggly lumpiness of this batter; it's meant to be this way.

Heat a few tablespoons of oil in a large frying pan and drop heaped dessertspoons of the mixture into the hot oil, flattening the little cakes down with the back of the spoon as you go. Cook these little patties for about 2 minutes each side until golden, and then transfer to a couple of waiting plates.

Chop up the limes and tumble them about the edges of the plates. Sprinkle over a little more chopped mint and eat them just as they are, spritzed with lime juice as you go.



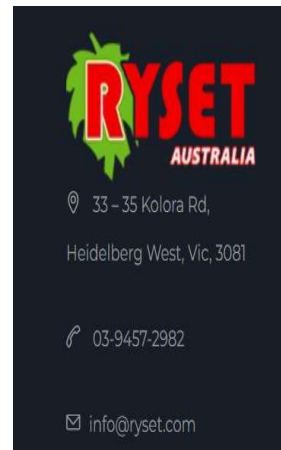
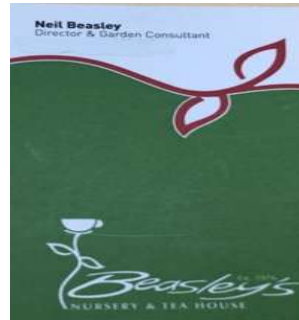
DGC Life Members	
Gerda van der Peet Doug Brewer Ken Beer Toni Myers Gayle McCann	Ted Page Joanne Driver Elsie Carter Bev Turner Franziska Kung

Doncaster Garden Club Inc. Membership 2026

Annual fees are due every October, those who have not paid for 2026 please do so at your earliest

Please complete the membership form on the Clubs website:
<https://doncastergardenclubaus.com/becomeamember>

Newsletters are emailed every month. For those wishing a hard-copy, please provide a self-addressed stamped envelope to the Club Secretary Connie or Virginia.



The Catalogue can be found online : <https://ryset.com>
The Club receives wholesale prices which means discounts of up to 60-70%



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